Cover Letter

Building Experience Design Internships - LEGO Building Experience, Research & Analytics

Dear LEGO Group,

I Mikiel Cassar and I am writing to express my utmost interest in the autumn internship position in LEGO building experience, research and analytics. As a trained social designer and design anthropologist with over three years of direct experience in user and market research, and a lifelong passion for LEGO, I believe I am well suited to contribute to the LEGO Group's mission.

The planning, conducting, and application of rigorous research has been the keystone of my educational and professional experience. I hold a First-Class Honours undergraduate degree in Anthropology with Sociology from the University of Malta where I specialised in human focused, participatory, and collaborative research methods, with a focus on design anthropology and culture. This foundation, combined with the drive to apply research creatively, drew me to my current Master of Arts in Social Design at the Nuova Accademia di Belle Arti in Milan. Here I have learned to meld active social research with traditional design methodologies to create and activate products, spaces, and communities. I am currently developing my thesis based on researching design for communicative play.

Alongside my studies, I have honed my research skills at EMCS, one of Malta's leading research companies, where I served as a lead market researcher. It was my role to develop research strategies, conduct surveys, interviews, and focus groups, and carry out the final analysis and report writing. My work supported clients ranging from local companies and NGOs to international clients such as Nestlé and the European Commission, with my research covering products, initiatives, cultural insights, and demographic and economic trends.

This multidisciplinary background and holistic skillset uniquely position me to serve as interpreter between consumers and designers. My anthropological background enables me to skilfully conduct all stages of research, while my design training allows me to translate these insights into concrete design recommendations and final outcomes, whether for products, communicative materials, services, or experiences.

Through these experiences, I have become highly familiar with multicultural, multidisciplinary, and multi-stakeholder situations, aligning seamlessly with the collaborative development ethos of the LEGO Group. Whether working on long term, high resource projects or fast paced, agile initiatives, I adapt quickly and deliver strong results.

The intersection between curiosity and creativity is where I have always sat. It is what drew me to LEGO, to anthropology, and to design. Whether producing The Sets That Built Me, an award winning podcast exploring the cultural and design impact of LEGO sets for Purple Radio, or running interviews and focus groups to develop new rug designs for Jaipur Rugs, I have always sought to understand, create, and empower.

These values, skills, and experiences position me strongly for this internship opportunity and align deeply with the LEGO Group's commitment to sustainable playful innovation. I would welcome the opportunity to contribute to your team, and I am sincerely grateful for your consideration. I look forward to hearing from you.

Many thanks,
Mikiel Cassar

